CHEF ARCHNA'S SPICE ROUTE:

A Culinary Journey Through India





Join renowned chef **Archna Becker of Bhojanic** for an unforgettable culinary journey through India, where centuries-old traditions, bold regional flavors, and vibrant culture come alive on every plate.

Known for blending authentic Indian cooking with modern sensibilities, Archna invites you to travel beyond the surface and into the heart of Indian cuisine through ***bustling spice markets***, ***hands-on cooking classes***, ***intimate family kitchens***, and ***curated meals at both humble eateries and heritage restaurants***. From the fragrant kebabs of Old Delhi to the rich curries of Rajasthan and the coastal delights of Kerala, this immersive experience offers a unique opportunity to explore India's diverse food landscape alongside a chef who knows it intimately.

Along the way, you'll discover not just recipes, but the stories, rituals, and relationships that shape India's soulful culinary heritage.

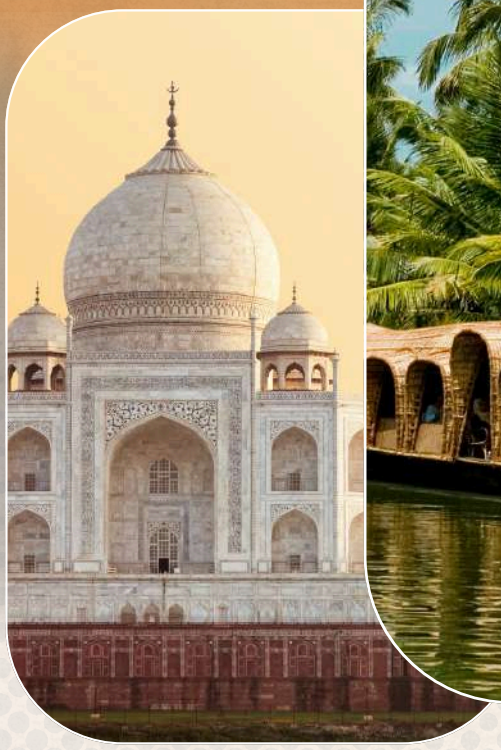
THE BASICS

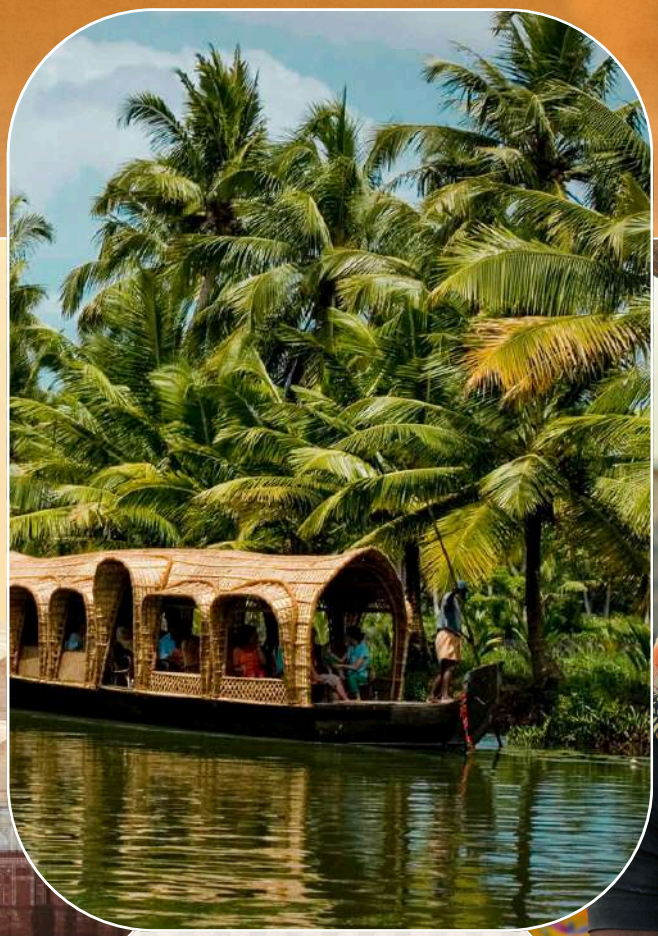
India:

A CULINARY AND CULTURAL JOURNEY

15 DAYS THROUGH
DELHI, AGRA, RAJASTHAN AND KERALA

FEBRUARY 15TH - MARCH 1ST







DAY 1

FEB 15

Delhi

WELCOME TO INDIA

Upon arrival at Indira Gandhi International Airport in the vibrant capital of New Delhi, you'll be warmly greeted and transferred to your hotel. After time to settle in and refresh, the group will gather this evening for an orientation meeting, where you'll receive an overview of the journey ahead — a journey centered on India's rich culinary traditions and the diverse cultural influences that continue to shape them.

There's no more fitting place to begin than Delhi — a city that has been the heart of the Indian subcontinent for centuries. As the capital of multiple empires, from the ancient Delhi Sultanate to the mighty Mughals and now modern India, Delhi has long been a crossroads of trade, migration, and innovation. Its cuisine reflects that layered history: a fusion of royal Mughlai indulgence, street food vibrancy, Persian spices, Punjabi heartiness, and colonial-era adaptations.

Following the orientation, we'll kick off our adventure with a special welcome dinner. Tonight's meal will introduce you to some of the iconic flavors of northern India: smoky tandoori kebabs, rich butter chicken, slow-cooked dals, fragrant biryanis, freshly baked naan and roti, and decadent sweets like gulab jamun and kheer.

More than just a meal, this dinner offers your first immersion into India's culinary language — one of spices, stories, and shared tables — and sets the tone for the flavorful journey ahead.

Accommodation: The Oberoi Maidens

Transportation: 45-minute private van transfer

Meals: Welcome dinner and drinks



DAY 2

FEB 16

Delhi

SACRED KITCHENS, STREET FOOD, AND MUGHAL MAJESTY

After breakfast at the hotel, we begin our day with a scenic drive through the grand avenues of New Delhi. You'll pass landmarks of India's colonial-era capital, including the President's Palace, Parliament House, and India Gate. This brief orientation drive offers a window into the city's 20th-century history and architectural ambitions.

From here, we shift into a space of service and spirituality at Gurudwara Bangla Sahib, one of Delhi's most important Sikh temples. At the heart of this sacred space is the langar, a community kitchen where 30,000-40,000 people are served free meals each day. Today, you'll have the opportunity to not only share in a simple, nourishing lunch of dal, roti, and kheer, but also to roll up your sleeves and volunteer — perhaps making fresh rotis or helping in the kitchen alongside local devotees. It's a powerful and humbling experience of collective generosity and shared humanity.

Next, we make a short stop at Dilli Haat, an open-air market that showcases India's rich craft traditions and culinary diversity. Here, artisans from across the country present regional textiles, handlooms, woodwork, and jewelry. The food court is equally vibrant, with stalls representing each Indian state — from spicy Assamese fish curry to Kashmiri kebabs and Goan coconut-laced dishes. It's a wonderful opportunity to sample lesser-known regional fare and pick up unique, handmade souvenirs.

In the late afternoon, we turn return to Old Delhi — where the atmosphere becomes electric with history and hustle. This is where Delhi truly comes alive, especially through its food. We'll stop to taste stuffed parathas, kachoris, and jalebis, made right before your eyes at tiny street-side stalls that have been operating for generations.

As night falls, we gather for dinner at the legendary Karim's, a culinary institution serving time-honored Mughal dishes just steps from the Jama Masjid, one of India's largest Mosque. Enjoy fragrant curries, charcoal-grilled kebabs, and rich stews that trace their lineage to royal kitchens as the sun sets on our first full day.



Accommodation: The Oberoi Maidens

Transportation: 1.5 hours private van transfer between sites

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner

DAY 3

FEB 17

Agra via Mathura

SACRED SITES, WILDLIFE AND THE TAJ MAHAL

After an early breakfast, we depart Delhi by road, making our first stop in Mathura, a sacred city along the Yamuna River closely tied to the life of Lord Krishna. Explore its ancient temples, stroll along the ghats, and sample pedas, the city's signature sweet made from condensed milk and cardamom.

We then continue to Wildlife SOS, a remarkable rescue and rehabilitation center devoted to protecting India's elephants and sloth bears. Learn about their conservation efforts and see these gentle animals thriving in a safe, caring environment.

By early afternoon, we arrive in Agra, a city steeped in Mughal history and culinary tradition. Enjoy a flavorful Mughlai lunch at a local restaurant, featuring creamy kormas, tender curries, and fragrant rice with soft breads like naan and sheermal.

Later, visit the Taj Mahal, one of the most iconic monuments in the world. Built by Emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his wife Mumtaz Mahal, its stunning white marble and symmetrical design glow beautifully in the late afternoon sun.

As the day winds down, enjoy a serene private boat ride on the Yamuna River, watching the sunset cast a golden hue on the Taj Mahal — a truly unforgettable perspective of this world wonder.

That evening, gather for a special, relaxing dinner with views of the illuminated Taj, a fitting end to a day filled with heritage, and breathtaking beauty.



Accommodation: ITC Mughal

Transportation: 3-4 hour private transfer

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner

DAY 4

FEB 18

Udaipur

CITY OF LAKES AND EVENING ON THE WATER

Begin your day with a relaxed breakfast in Agra — a peaceful moment to savor after several days of rich exploration. Late in the morning, travel back to Delhi for your flight to Udaipur, where a different rhythm awaits. Nestled in the Aravalli Hills, Udaipur, often called the City of Lakes, welcomes you with its dreamy landscapes, soft golden light, and romantic, whitewashed architecture.

As you arrive and settle into your hotel, you'll feel time slow down. The city's graceful beauty is immediate and immersive — from its mirror-like lakes and vibrant bazaars to the faded grandeur of its palaces.

This evening, set out for a private cruise on Lake Pichola. Glide past age-old ghats, noble havelis, and the striking facade of the City Palace, all bathed in the warm light of sunset. As the sky turns dusky rose and lamps flicker to life along the water's edge, you'll dock at Jagmandir Island Palace — a regal 17th-century structure in the heart of the lake.

Here, enjoy a magical dinner beneath the open sky. Surrounded by the still waters and glowing city lights, you'll dine on a menu that reflects the essence of Rajasthani cuisine: deeply spiced curries, slow-cooked meats, delicate flatbreads, and seasonal vegetables prepared with heritage techniques. Though the setting is opulent, the flavors remain soulful — a tribute to Rajasthan's culinary traditions.
As the night deepens, return by boat and head back to your hotel, feeling fully immersed in the calm and splendor of Udaipur.



Accommodation: The Radisson Blu or similar

Transportation: 3 hour private transfer, 1 hour 20 minute flight

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner

DAY 5

FEB 19

Udaipur

FOOD, SUSTAINABILITY AND THE SOUL OF THE CITY

Spend your day wandering through the enchanting old town of Udaipur, where every vibrant lane tells a story through color, scent, and flavor. The streets buzz with life, alive with the aromas of spices, fresh herbs, and sizzling street food. Begin your morning with a Wisdom Walk — an immersive food tour that interweaves the city's deep culinary roots with its forward-thinking approach to sustainability.

Guided by local experts, you'll explore neighborhood eateries and bustling markets committed to low-waste practices, local sourcing, and support for small-scale producers. Along the way, discover how Udaipur is reimagining its food systems — from composting and zero-waste packaging to reviving regional ingredients once lost to industrial agriculture. Taste everyday delights like poha and tangy pethas, sample organic sweets, and visit shops focused on minimal plastic use and kitchens where nothing goes to waste. Enjoy tea with a local family in their historic haveli as your learn about Mewari heritage.

In the evening, head to Millets of Mewar, a pioneering restaurant at the forefront of India's millet renaissance. Meet the chef-founder and learn how this community-driven space is using native grains — like finger millet, barnyard millet, and kodo millet — not only for their nutritional benefits, but as a way to revive climate-resilient food traditions. The meal is as meaningful as it is delicious — a true celebration of heritage, sustainability, and innovation.

Accommodation: The Radisson Blu or similar

Activity: 2-3 hour walking tour

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 6

FEB 20

Udaipur

PALACES, PUPPETS AND THE PULSE OF RAJASTHAN

Start your day with a visit to the magnificent City Palace, a crown jewel of Udaipur's skyline. Perched above the shimmering waters of Lake Pichola, this grand complex of palaces, courtyards, and balconies tells the story of the Mewar dynasty with every intricate detail. Wander through mirrored halls, marble corridors, and mosaic-lined chambers, pausing on a sunlit terrace to take in the panoramic views of the lake and the Aravalli Hills beyond. The morning here feels timeless—serene, elegant, and steeped in the grandeur of Rajasthan's royal past.

In the afternoon, connect with Udaipur's vibrant artistic soul. Visit a local art studio to meet master miniature painters, where centuries-old techniques bring epic tales and fine brushwork to life. Or spend time with traditional Kathputli puppet-makers—craftspeople who have passed down their skills through generations. You may also choose to engage with a grassroots nonprofit blending music and community, where traditional instruments and local youth come together in a dynamic celebration of cultural resilience.

As night falls, tuck into a traditional Rajasthani thali at a popular local eatery. Here, generous platters arrive brimming with specialties like dal baati churma, gatte ki sabzi, and ker sangri, served with warm hospitality and the lively hum of everyday diners.

Your final evening in Udaipur unfolds in the courtyard of a historic haveli, where flickering lanterns and starry skies set the stage for a joyful performance of Rajasthani folk music and dance. The beat of the dholak, the soulful strains of the sarangi, and the swirl of colorful costumes bring your time in the City of Lakes to a memorable and magical close.

Accommodation: The Radisson Blu or similar

Activity: 2-3 hour walking tour

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 7

FEB 21

Kochi

FROM DESERT TO COAST

This morning, take a flight from Udaipur to Kochi, trading the ochre tones of the Rajasthani desert for the emerald canopy and palm-lined waters of Kerala's Malabar Coast. As your plane descends over the Arabian Sea, you'll catch your first glimpse of Kerala's lush backwaters and the vibrant patchwork of its tropical landscape.

After checking in to your hotel, take the afternoon to explore the historic quarter of Fort Kochi—a place where cultures have collided and blended for centuries. Once a key stop on the global spice route, Kochi drew traders, missionaries, and colonizers from across the world, each leaving their mark on this coastal city. Here, the scent of pepper, cardamom, cinnamon, and clove still lingers in the air, a reminder of the cargoes that once made Kochi one of the most valuable ports in Asia.

As dusk falls, we will settle in at a seafront restaurant for a relaxed dinner where Kerala's coastal bounty is on the menu—Karimeen pollichathu, prawns moilee, or crab in coconut masala—served with accompaniments like appam, lemon rice, and vegetable thoran. Kochi, Kerala offers a gentle welcome to this soulful, spice-scented land.

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Accommodation: Brunton Boat Yard or Similar
Transportation: 3 hour flight time with layover
Activity: 1-2 hour walking tour
Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 8

FEB 22

Kochi

SPICE ROUTES AND SUNSET TABLES

After breakfast, set out on a guided walking tour of Fort Kochi, a coastal enclave where centuries of global trade have left behind a rich tapestry of architecture and culture. As one of the world's famed spice entrepôts, Fort Kochi's streets are lined with Portuguese mansions, Dutch colonial churches, Jewish synagogues, and British bungalows—all nestled under the shade of ancient rain trees. Along the waterfront, you'll encounter the iconic Chinese fishing nets, still operated using a 14th-century technique introduced by traders from the court of Kublai Khan.

Wander through the neighborhood's spice shops, where towering jars of cardamom, pepper, cinnamon, and clove nod to Kerala's enduring place in the spice trade. Browse local boutiques and art galleries that reflect the city's vibrant contemporary culture, or simply enjoy a chai at a quiet café as life unfolds slowly around you.

As twilight falls, embark on the Nilavala Twilight Dinner, a one-of-a-kind dining experience on a traditional Chinese fishing net platform set over the water. After a tranquil boat ride across the Veeranpuzha backwaters, you'll arrive at your open-air dining table where you'll be served a beautifully prepared coastal meal—Kerala porotta, patthiri, steamed tapioca with fish curry, crisp fish fry, and prawns, accompanied by sulaimani tea. With the sun setting over the Arabian Sea and the gentle sway of the nets above you, it's a magical way to experience Kerala's culinary soul and support a local community-driven initiative.



Accommodation: Brunton Boat Yard or Similar
Transportation: Tuk Tuk and Backwater motor boat
Activity: 3-4 hours walking tour
Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner

DAY 9

FEB 23

Kochi

LAYERS OF HISTORY

The morning is relaxed to give you time to reset and explore these enchanting streets . As one of the world's famed entrepôts, Fort Kochi's landscape bears the imprint of centuries of global exchange, shaped by the traders and settlers who passed through its shores. The streets are lined with Portuguese mansions, Dutch colonial churches, Jewish synagogues, and British-era bungalows, all tucked into leafy lanes shaded by broad-canopied rain trees. Along the waterfront, the silhouette of Chinese fishing nets—introduced in the 14th century by traders from the court of Kublai Khan—still rises and falls with the tide. As you explore, you might pause at a neighborhood spice shop, where towering jars display the fragrant wealth of Kerala's spice gardens, or step into a local gallery, where Fort Kochi's creative energy lives on through contemporary art, photography, and design.

That afternoon we will explore The Kochi-Muziris Biennale which is India's largest contemporary art festival, uniquely set in historic spice warehouses and heritage buildings of Fort Kochi, blending global experimental art with Kerala's rich cultural and community spirit. It transforms the city into a vibrant open-air museum where history and cutting-edge creativity meet.

In the early evening, witness a live performance of Kalaripayattu, Kerala's traditional martial art. Combining fluid movement, fierce combat, and meditative discipline, this centuries-old practice offers a powerful glimpse into the region's warrior heritage. We will wrap up our day with another delightful meal of Kerala cuisine.

Accommodation: Brunton Boat Yard

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 10

FEB 24

Kochi

RELAX AND REFRESH

Kerala, often called “God’s Own Country,” is not only blessed with palm-fringed backwaters and lush spice gardens, but also with a living tradition of Ayurveda, India’s ancient science of life. For centuries, the region has been a global crossroads of trade, with ships once carrying pepper, cardamom, and cinnamon from Kochi’s harbor to the world. These same spices, alongside countless native herbs, have also been treasured in Ayurveda for their healing and restorative powers.

Begin the day with a gentle yoga session, designed to open body and mind in harmony with Kerala’s serene natural surroundings. Afterward, you may choose from optional activities—a leisurely bike ride past coconut groves and village lanes, or kayaking through tranquil waterways.

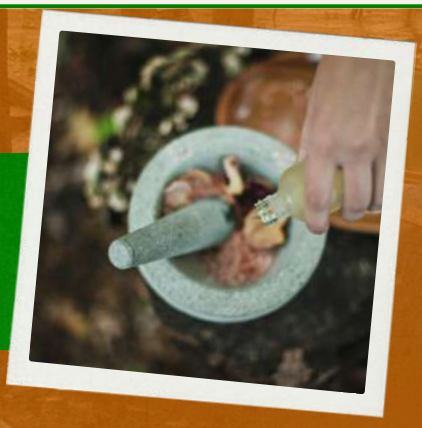
In the afternoon, you’ll meet a local Ayurvedic doctor, who will share insights into this centuries-old practice. Discover how turmeric is used to cool inflammation, tulsi to calm the spirit, ashwagandha to restore strength, and ginger to awaken digestion. More than just treatments, Ayurveda is a way of life: a philosophy that seeks balance between food, sleep, work, and the rhythms of nature.

Your’ll come to see how Ayurveda remains deeply woven into everyday life in Kerala—whether through home remedies passed down generations, temple rituals involving sacred plants, or modern wellness centers that continue this timeless practice.

Accommodation: Brunton Boat Yard

Transportation: Optional bikiing or kayaking

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 11

FEB 25

Munnar

MISTY HILLS

Today, leave the coastal rhythms of Kochi behind and begin your journey into the verdant highlands of Kerala. As you drive inland, the scenery gradually transforms—flat, tropical terrain gives way to undulating hills blanketed with spice groves and tea plantations, the air turning cooler with every mile.

Along the way, stop in a small village nestled in the foothills, where you'll be welcomed into a local home for a hands-on cooking experience. Step into the kitchen with your host to learn the art of Kerala home cooking—from hand-grinding coconut for chutneys to tempering mustard seeds, curry leaves, and tamarind in hot oil. Cook together over a traditional wood-fired stove, preparing a simple yet richly flavored meal that highlights the soul of the region's cuisine.

After lunch, take a short stroll through the surrounding landscape, discovering pepper vines, cacao trees, rubber plants, and other spices growing in their natural habitat—a quiet glimpse into Kerala's agricultural heart.

Continue your drive into the Western Ghats, winding through tea estates, misty forests, and waterfalls. By late afternoon, arrive in Munnar, a hill station once favored by British planters. Settle into your hotel, take in the cool mountain air, and enjoy a peaceful evening surrounded by the timeless beauty of the hills.

Accommodation: Fragrant Nature

Transportation: 3 hour transfer

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 12

FEB 26

Munnar

TEA, SPICES AND MARKETS

Spend your day in Munnar immersed in the lush, green hills that produce two of Kerala's most celebrated exports: tea and spices. Begin your morning at a local tea estate, where the landscape is shaped by manicured rows of tea bushes stretching across the slopes. Walk through the estate and learn how tea is grown, hand-plucked, and processed, then step inside a working factory to see the transformation from leaf to brew. End your visit with a tasting session, comparing the delicate notes of black, green, and white teas unique to the region.

Next, continue to a nearby spice plantation, where a guided walk takes you through dense groves alive with the scent of cardamom, pepper, clove, and cinnamon. Your guide will share insights into how these spices are cultivated and used—not only in cooking, but also in traditional medicine and Ayurvedic practices. Keep an eye out for nutmeg trees and vanilla orchids hidden among the undergrowth.

Pause for lunch at a local restaurant or plantation kitchen, where dishes are seasoned with the very spices you've just encountered—fragrant curries, spiced stews, and chutneys layered with flavor.

In the afternoon, explore the small market in Munnar town, browsing stalls filled with fresh tea, spice packets, and locally made crafts. Return to your hotel for a restful evening in the cool mountain air, perhaps sipping a cup of tea as the sun sets over the hills.



Accommodation: Fragrant Nature

Transportation: 3 hour transfer

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner

DAY 13

FEB 27

Alleppey

FROM HILLTOP TO WATERWAY

Start your day in Munnar with an optional early morning hike through the misty hills, where narrow trails wind through emerald tea plantations, ancient shola forests, and wildflower-filled meadows. The cool air is rich with the scent of tea leaves and birdsong, and panoramic views open up around every bend—a serene and energizing beginning to the day.

After your walk, enjoy a simple local breakfast before setting off on your journey down from the highlands toward the palm-lined backwaters of Kerala.
Tea estates gradually give way to spice plantations, coconut groves, and glimmering rivers. By early afternoon, you'll arrive at your kettuvallam—a traditional Kerala houseboat crafted from bamboo, coir, and wood—waiting for you along the tranquil canals. These slow-moving floating homes offer a unique perspective on village life along the waterways, where daily rhythms unfold to the sound of paddles and birdsong.

Settle in and relax as your houseboat glides gently through narrow channels and wide lagoons.

As evening falls, enjoy dinner on deck, watching as the sky turns to gold and village lights begin to flicker on across the water.

Accommodation: Spice Routes House

Transportation: 3 hour transfer and overnight boatcruise

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner



DAY 14

FEB 28

Marari Beach

COASTAL CALM

Enjoy a leisurely morning aboard the houseboat, savoring a final breakfast as the boat glides gently through Kerala's peaceful backwaters. Watch as daily life unfolds on the water's edge—fishermen casting nets, children on their way to school, and quiet scenes of coconut groves and village homes slipping by.

After disembarking, begin your scenic drive to Marari Beach, a tranquil coastal haven tucked along Kerala's Arabian Sea shore. Arrive at your resort by early afternoon, a property that blends sustainable luxury with a strong connection to the local landscape and community.

Take the afternoon to wander through the interactive organic farm, where you can pluck fresh herbs, learn about indigenous vegetables, and see how traditional farming practices support both the kitchen and the community. Join the chef for a cooking session using ingredients harvested just moments before.

As the day draws to a close, enjoy a final walk along the beach or a bike ride to the local villages as the sun sets in warm gold across the sea. In the evening, gather for a farewell dinner under the stars, where dishes feature seafood pulled from the ocean that morning, vegetables from the garden, and the distinct, soulful flavors of Kerala. It's a celebration of the land, the people, and the journey you've taken.



Accommodation: Marari Beach Resort

Transportation: 2 hour transfer

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch and Dinner

DAY 15

Farewell

DEPARTURE

Wake up to the gentle rhythm of the waves on your final morning in Kerala. Enjoy a leisurely breakfast at the resort, perhaps with one last cup of spiced chai or fresh tropical fruit, savoring the quiet of Marari before the journey home. After breakfast, you'll be transferred to the Cochin International Airport for your departure.



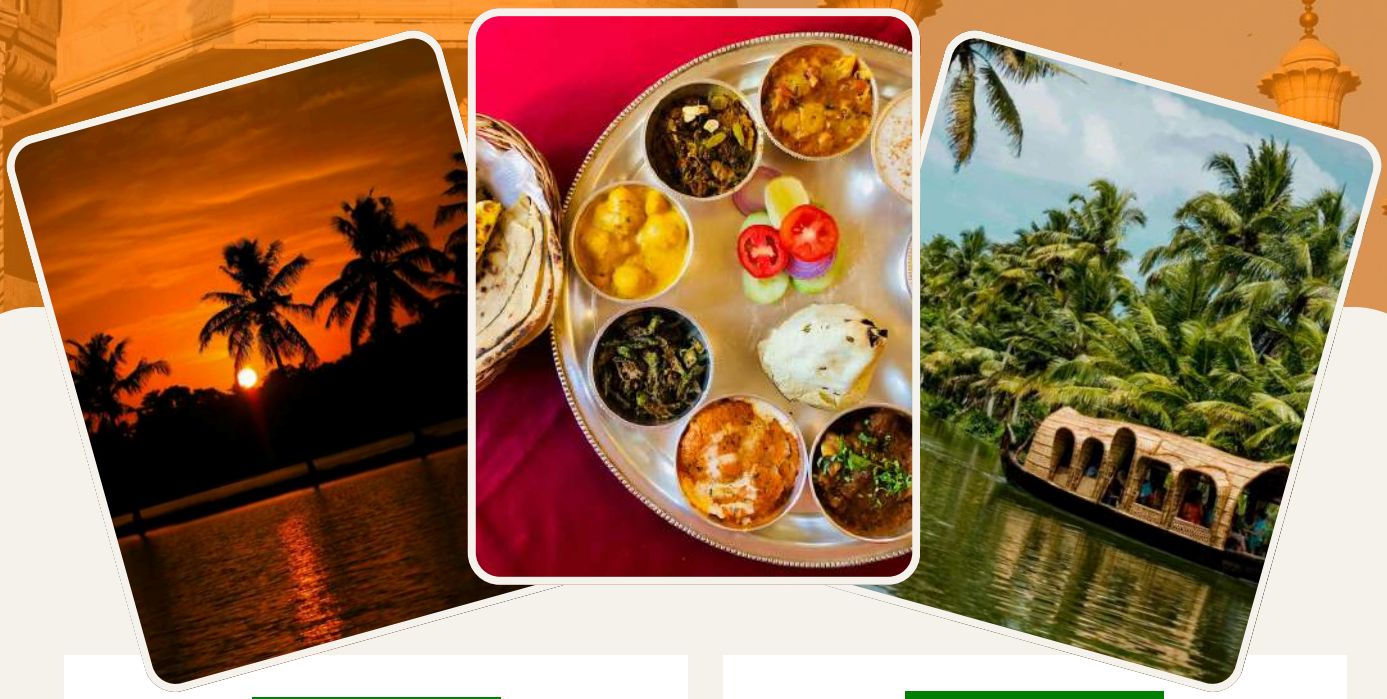
Transportation: 2 hour transfer to airport

Meals: Breakfast

Tour Package:

$8,999 PRICE PER PERSON BASED ON DDL OCCUPANCY

$2,500 SINGLE PERSON SUPPLEMENT



INCLUSIONS

- Private transportation and private driver
- Meals as mentioned
- Welcome and Farewell Meal Alcoholic Drinks
- Double Room Accommodation
- Private Guide and Drivers
- Entrance fees to all sites and activities mentioned

EXCLUSIONS

- Personal expenses
- Travel insurance
- All flights (both international and connecting)
- Internal flights not included. Estimated at $500 per person.
- Visa fees
- Bank fees
- Alcoholic beverages outside of welcome and farewell dinner
- Spa treatments
- Tips to guide and drivers